

FEDERAL SYSTEM

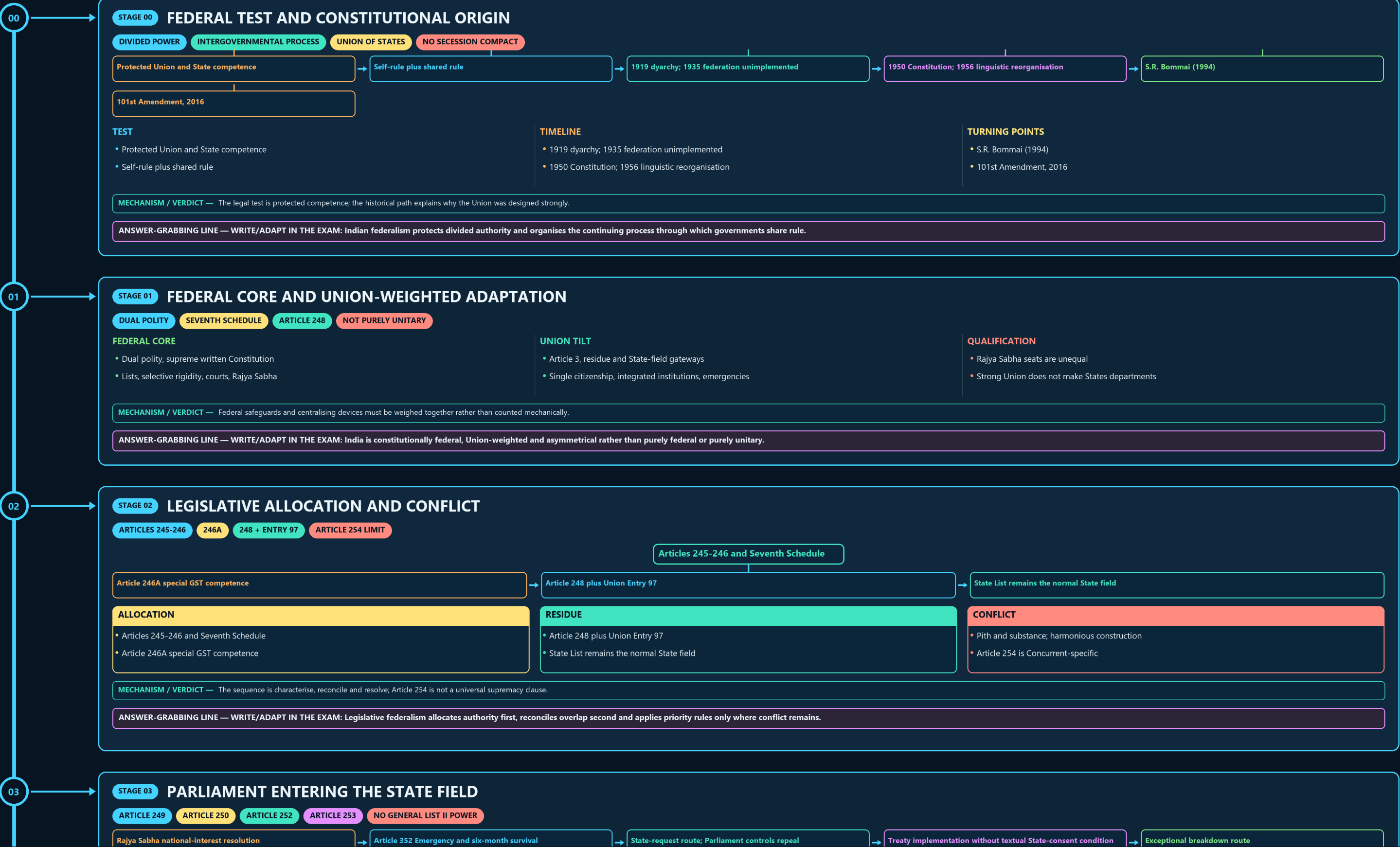
FEDERAL TEST -> HISTORY -> FEATURES -> FOUR BALANCES -> ASYMMETRY -> REFORM -> VERDICT

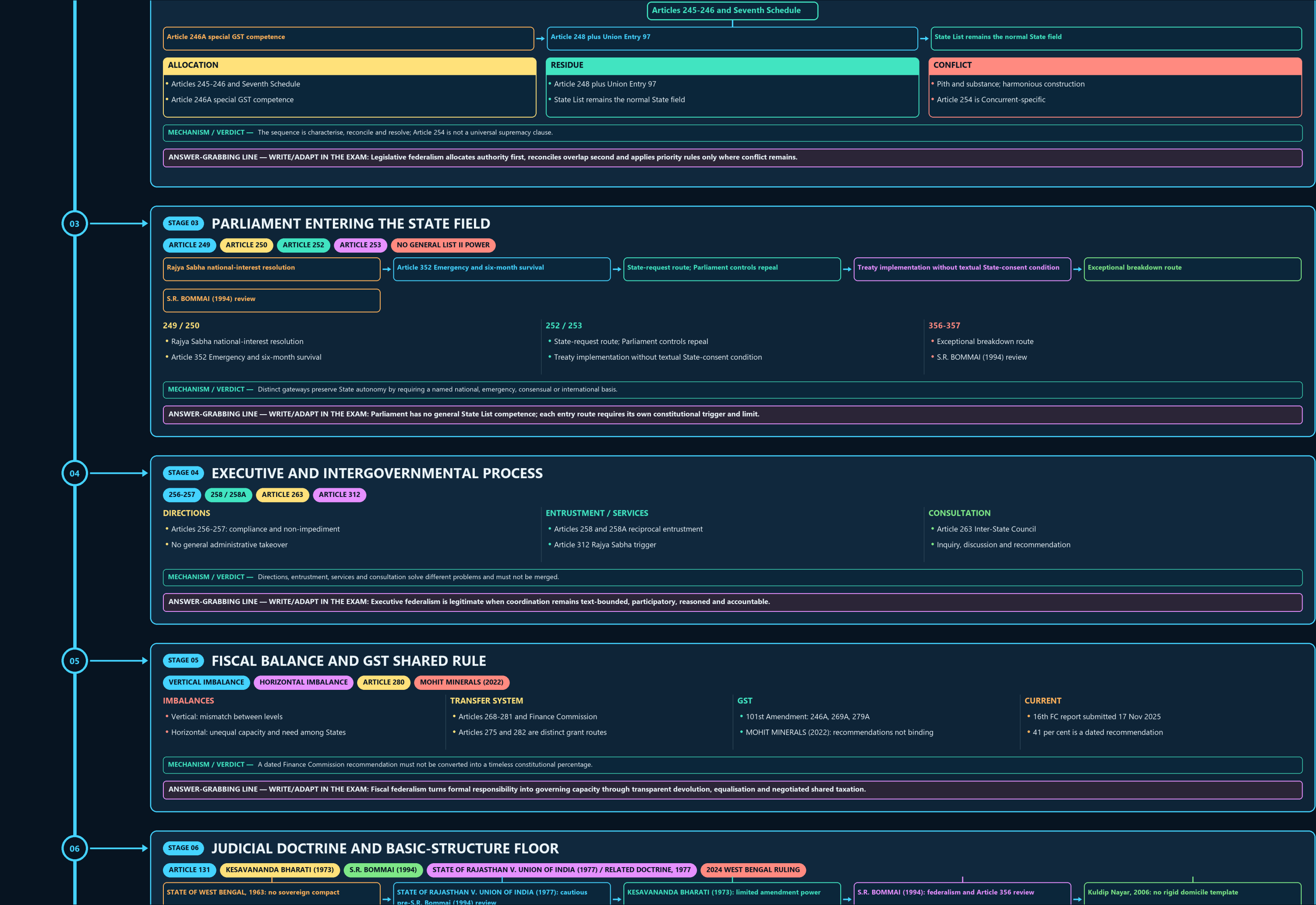
Follow the cyan rail from the federal test to the integrated verdict. The final grey stage is optional analytical enrichment.

- PRIMARY CORE FLOW
- SUBORDINATE EXTRA
- APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE; pending user review; prior artifacts unchanged during rendering.

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles





05

STAGE 05

FISCAL BALANCE AND GST SHARED RULE

VERTICAL IMBALANCE

HORIZONTAL IMBALANCE

ARTICLE 280

MOHIT MINERALS (2022)

IMBALANCES

Vertical: mismatch between levels

Horizontal: unequal capacity and need among States

TRANSFER SYSTEM

Articles 268-281 and Finance Commission

Articles 275 and 282 are distinct grant routes

GST

101st Amendment: 246A, 269A, 279A

MOHIT MINERALS (2022): recommendations not binding

CURRENT

16th FC report submitted 17 Nov 2025

41 per cent is a dated recommendation

MECHANISM / VERDICT

A dated Finance Commission recommendation must not be converted into a timeless constitutional percentage.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE

WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Fiscal federalism turns formal responsibility into governing capacity through transparent devolution, equalisation and negotiated shared taxation.

06

STAGE 06

JUDICIAL DOCTRINE AND BASIC-STRUCTURE FLOOR

ARTICLE 131

KESAVANANDA BHARATI (1973)

S.R. BOMMAI (1994)

STATE OF RAJASTHAN V. UNION OF INDIA (1977) / RELATED DOCTRINE, 1977

2024 WEST BENGAL RULING

STATE OF WEST BENGAL, 1963: no sovereign compact

STATE OF RAJASTHAN V. UNION OF INDIA (1977): cautious pre-S.R. Bommai (1994) review

KESAVANANDA BHARATI (1973): limited amendment power

S.R. BOMMAI (1994): federalism and Article 356 review

Kuldip Nayar, 2006: no rigid domicile template

MOHIT MINERALS (2022): legislative autonomy

2024 West Bengal ruling: Article 131 suit maintainable

CBI-consent merits were not finally decided

EARLY POSITION

STATE OF WEST BENGAL, 1963: no sovereign compact

STATE OF RAJASTHAN V. UNION OF INDIA (1977): cautious pre-S.R. Bommai (1994) review

BASIC STRUCTURE

KESAVANANDA BHARATI (1973): limited amendment power

S.R. BOMMAI (1994): federalism and Article 356 review

LATER REFINEMENT

Kuldip Nayar, 2006: no rigid domicile template

MOHIT MINERALS (2022): legislative autonomy

RECENT

2024 West Bengal ruling: Article 131 suit maintainable

CBI-consent merits were not finally decided

MECHANISM / VERDICT

Holdings must be separated from inference, and preliminary rulings must not be presented as final merits decisions.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE

WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The judiciary protects a minimum federal floor but cannot replace political consultation or fiscal bargaining.

07

STAGE 07

ASYMMETRY, DELHI AND JAMMU AND KASHMIR

ASYMMETRICAL FEDERALISM

FIFTH / SIXTH SCHEDULES

ARTICLE 239AA

COMMON CITIZENSHIP

NO LIVE ARTICLE 370 STATUS

Articles 371-371J are State-specific

Article 239AA special Union Territory design

NCT Delhi 2018 and 2023 judgments

Fifth Schedule differs from Sixth Schedule

TRIBAL / STATE

Fifth Schedule differs from Sixth Schedule

Articles 371-371J are State-specific

DELHI

Article 239AA special Union Territory design

NCT Delhi 2018 and 2023 judgments

JAMMU AND KASHMIR

Article 370 judgment, 11 Dec 2023

2019 changes upheld; no statehood-restoration date fixed

MECHANISM / VERDICT

Different constitutional arrangements do not imply different grades of Indian citizenship.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE

WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Asymmetry adapts territorial institutions while preserving one citizenship and one constitutional order.

08

STAGE 08

WORKING MODES AND FUNCTIONAL FEDERALISM

COOPERATION

COMPETITION

BARGAINING

FUNCTIONAL FEDERALISM

LOCAL != CO-SOVEREIGN

MODES

Cooperative, competitive and bargaining

Confrontational and coercive pressures

FUNCTIONS

GST, health, disasters and infrastructure

Cross-border tasks require joint implementation

LOCAL TIER

Parts IX and IXA recognise local government

Articles 243G/243W make devolution State-mediated

MECHANISM / VERDICT

A third governance tier is not a third co-sovereign constituent layer of the federation.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE

WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Territorial allocation remains the legal base while functional interdependence explains how modern government actually operates.

FEDERAL SYSTEM • TILE 3/4 • same master rows 4519-7753 of 10013 • continues below

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Different constitutional arrangements do not imply different grades of Indian citizenship.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Asymmetry adapts territorial institutions while preserving one citizenship and one constitutional order.

08

STAGE 08

WORKING MODES AND FUNCTIONAL FEDERALISM

COOPERATION

COMPETITION

BARGAINING

FUNCTIONAL FEDERALISM

LOCAL != CO-SOVEREIGN

MODES

- Cooperative, competitive and bargaining
- Confrontational and coercive pressures

FUNCTIONS

- GST, health, disasters and infrastructure
- Cross-border tasks require joint implementation

LOCAL TIER

- Parts IX and IXA recognise local government
- Articles 243G/243W make devolution State-mediated

MECHANISM / VERDICT — A third governance tier is not a third co-sovereign constituent layer of the federation.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Territorial allocation remains the legal base while functional interdependence explains how modern government actually operates.

09

STAGE 09

CHALLENGES AND REFORM CHANNELS

CONSTITUTIONAL TRUST

PREDICTABLE FINANCE

NEUTRAL GOVERNOR

S.R. BOMMAI (1994) DISCIPLINE

NO ABSOLUTE LABEL

POLITICAL

- Governor friction and Article 356 misuse
- Regional representation and inter-State disputes

FISCAL

- Cesses, conditional schemes and borrowing
- GST autonomy and common-market tension

INSTITUTIONAL

- Regular Inter-State Council and stronger scrutiny
- Prompt reasons, floor tests and neutral offices

LOCAL

- Functions, funds and staff
- Consultation before standardisation

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Reform should improve the manner of exercising power without disabling national action for genuine externalities.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Union capacity earns federal legitimacy when exercised through competence, necessity, consultation, reasons and review.

10

STAGE 10

INTEGRATED ANSWER SPINE AND VERDICT

CLAIM

NAMED EVIDENCE

MECHANISM

QUALIFICATION

GRADED VERDICT

Define; trace history; establish federal features

→

Weigh Union tilt through exact Articles

→

Legislative, executive, fiscal and judicial balances

→

Asymmetry, operating modes and current cases

→

Challenge, counterpoint and precise reform

Constitutionally federal, Union-weighted, asymmetrical

BUILD

- Define; trace history; establish federal features
- Weigh Union tilt through exact Articles

ANALYSE

- Legislative, executive, fiscal and judicial balances
- Asymmetry, operating modes and current cases

EVALUATE

- Challenge, counterpoint and precise reform
- Constitutionally federal, Union-weighted, asymmetrical

MECHANISM / VERDICT — A strong Union and protected States are compatible when power remains bounded, financed, consultative and reviewable.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The best answer proves a federal core, qualifies Union predominance and evaluates whether intergovernmental practice preserves constitutional trust.

E

EXTRA

OPTIONAL SCHOLAR AND COMPARATIVE LIFT

OPTIONAL DEPTH

SCHOLAR LABELS

COMPARATIVE MODELS

CORE ALREADY COMPLETE

SCHOLARS

- Wheare: quasi-federal; Austin: cooperative
- Morris-Jones: bargaining; Alexandrowicz: sui generis

COMPARISON

- United States: coming-together and equal Senate
- Canada: strong-centre comparison

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional enrichment is unnecessary for a competent core answer and must remain subordinate to constitutional analysis.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels

FEDERAL SYSTEM • TILE 4/4 • same master rows 6779-10013 of 10013 • end